“Everyone else has real friends but me.”

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Where it often comes from

Social media, church directories, and group photos make it look as if everyone else has a full circle of close friends. Life changes such as moves, marriage, parenting, job changes, and illness can thin out friendships. The longer we are lonely, the more we assume that others never are.

What Scripture teaches

Solomon observes, “Two are better than one… For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!” Proverbs says, “As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another.” God knows loneliness: the psalmist prays, “Turn to me and be gracious, for I am lonely and afflicted,” and the author of Hebrews urges, “Let us not neglect meeting together… but let us encourage one another.” Many people feel the same ache. Friendship is built, not found fully formed, and God uses ordinary steps to bring friends.

> *“Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!”* (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

Also see

> “As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another” (Proverbs 27:17).

> “Turn to me and be gracious, for I am lonely and afflicted” (Psalm 25:16).

> “And let us consider how to spur one another on to love and good deeds. Let us not neglect meeting together, as some have made a habit, but let us encourage one another, and all the more as you see the Day approaching” (Hebrews 10:24–25).

> “A man of many companions may come to ruin, but there is a friend who stays closer than a brother” (Proverbs 18:24).

Common self-statements

- Everyone else has a best friend.
- I am the only one who has no one.
- I missed the window for making friends.
- Other people connect so easily.
- I will always be alone.
- No one calls me.

Common logical errors

- Social comparison: Comparing my private life with others’ public moments.
- Mental filter: Noticing the lack of friends and missing existing connections.
- Overgeneralizing: Assuming that everyone else has what I lack.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always be lonely.

Challenging questions

- Is it true that everyone else has close friends? How do I know?
- Who is a casual acquaintance who could become a friend?
- What did my past friendships need to grow?
- What stops me from reaching out?
- What does Scripture say about loneliness and God's nearness?
- What is one concrete step I can take this week?

Truth summary

> Loneliness is common, even when others look connected. Friendships are built over time through small, repeated steps. God sees my loneliness, and He can lead me to friends and use this season for good.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Friendship
- Church
- Love, For Others
- Thankful

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus — Keith and Kristyn Getty
This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Everyone else has real friends but me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Everyone else has real friends but me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Is it true that everyone else has close friends?
- ☐ Who could become a friend?
- ☐ What stops me from reaching out?
- ☐ What group could I join?
- ☐ What step can I take?
- ☐ How can I pray?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Many people feel lonely.
- ☐ Two are better than one.
- ☐ Friendships grow slowly.
- ☐ God sees my loneliness.
- ☐ I can take one step this week.
- ☐ Community is worth the effort.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:9–10
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"
- ☐ Proverbs 27:17
  "As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another."
- ☐ Hebrews 10:24–25
  "And let us consider how to spur one another on to love and good deeds. Let us not neglect meeting together, as some have made a habit, but let us encourage one another, and all the more as you see the Day approaching."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] A step toward friendship: Each week, write the step you took and how it went.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Ecclesiastes 4:9–10 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Two are better than one, so I will take a step toward a friend.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Loneliness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] List acquaintances. Write five people who could become friends.
- [ ] Invite someone. Ask one person to coffee, a walk, or a meal.
- [ ] Join a recurring group. Commit to a group that meets weekly.
- [ ] Pray about it. Ask God to bring a friend and show you whom to reach out to.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Everyone else has real friends but me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A step toward friendship
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Everyone else has real friends but me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You know how lonely I feel. Bring friends into my life and give me courage to reach out. Help me be a friend as well as find one. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.